

CraftCircle

Local Artisan Bulk Buying Club

Pool orders from local artisans, share one delivery, and cut logistics cost by 61%.

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The problem and the opportunity

₹1,800

Individual shipping, 15.0% of a ₹12,000 order

₹700

Pooled shipping, 5.8% of the order

₹1,100

Saved per pooled order, a 61.1% cut

Problem statement

Urban households that prefer authentic local handmade goods cannot buy them affordably in small quantities, because every parcel carries a full individual shipping charge of about 15% of the basket.

Opportunity statement

By pooling demand into weekly order windows, CraftCircle can cut logistics to about 5.8% of order value, give artisans prepaid batched orders, and earn a commission for running the club.

Case data: pooled order ₹12,000; logistics ₹1,800 if shipped individually, ₹700 when consolidated · 2

Customers and value proposition

Primary segment: Neha, 34

Product manager in a Kharghar housing society, household income about ₹20 lakh. Buys handmade décor and gifts about 8 times a year, pays ₹200+ shipping on ₹1,200 baskets, and trusts her neighbours' recommendations.

Secondary: gifting buyers. Tertiary: cafés, studios and boutique stays.

Customer pain

CraftCircle answer

₹225 shipping on a ₹1,500 basket

₹87.50 through pooled shipping

Several parcels on different dates

One delivery per order window

Doubts about quality

Verified artisans, hub quality check, replacement promise

Hard to find local artisans

Curated catalogue with maker stories

How the club runs

1. Members pledge

Browse the catalogue and pledge items before the Sunday 8 pm cut-off.

2. Pool confirms

At ₹10,000 and 6 members, payment is captured. Otherwise the window extends once.

3. Orders to artisans

One purchase order per artisan, paid after dispatch is confirmed.

4. Artisans make, ship

Items are made or picked in 3-5 days and sent to the local hub.

5. Hub consolidates

Quality check, then per-member packing labelled by pod.

6. Pooled delivery

One shared trip for ₹700 to the pod pick-up point, with OTP at handover.

Window: Monday 9 am to Sunday 8 pm

Membership: ₹499 a year, ₹299 founding

Delivery: 7-10 days after cut-off

Revenue, costs and break-even

Per pooled order of ₹12,000

Commission, 12%	₹1,440
Membership share	₹333
Total revenue	₹1,773
Variable costs	-₹764
Contribution (8.4%)	₹1,009

A member saves ₹225 - ₹87.50 = ₹137.50 per order, so the ₹499 fee pays back in about 4 orders.

36 orders

a month to break even (₹36,000 ÷ ₹1,009)

62 orders

in 90 days, ₹7.44 lakh of order value

₹1.05 lakh

peak funding need, with ₹60,000 launch budget

Assumes 8 members per pooled order and one order a month per member · 5

SWOT and risks

Strengths
61% cheaper logistics
Prepaid, batched orders
Trusted neighbourhood pods

Weaknesses
7-10 day delivery
Needs pool volume
New brand, small team

Opportunities
Local, sustainable demand
Society WhatsApp reach
Festive and corporate gifting

Threats
Instagram sellers
Courier price rises
Artisans selling direct

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Pool misses ₹10,000	High	Pod captains, one 3-day extension, merge pods
Artisan delays or capacity limits	High	Two artisans per category, ready-stock items
Damage or quality mismatch	Medium	Hub check, packing standards, replacement promise
Cash-flow strain	High	Charge on confirmation, pay after dispatch
Slow member growth	High	Two channels, founding price, referral credits

Go-to-market and 90-day plan

Channel 1: society pods

A volunteer captain per housing society, a demo order in the WhatsApp group, ₹299 founding price. Target: 300 members.

Channel 2: artisans and pop-ups

Artisans invite their followers with join links; weekend pop-ups with QR sign-up. Target: 150 members.

Days 1–30: Prepare

15 artisans, 100 items, 3 pods, 100 founding members, 4 test pools

Days 31–60: Pilot

6 pods, 250 members, 18 pooled orders, tune cut-off and hub flow

Days 61–90: Scale

10 pods, 450 members, 40 pooled orders a month, above break-even

Success at day 90: 450 members · 85% of pools fill · 90% on-time delivery · under 2% damage · 40% repeat · NPS 50+ · CAC ₹150 or less

Launch budget ₹60,000; peak funding need about ₹1.05 lakh · 7

Summary

Thank you

Pooling cuts logistics from ₹1,800 to ₹700, and 36 pooled orders a month makes CraftCircle break even.

Questions are welcome.